

Design Plan Timeline

Pre-close through the Week 4 install. This is the design lane of the Six-Week Launch (that checklist is in this pack); run the two side by side. The clock starts before closing, because escrow is prep time, not waiting time. Every week the home isn't listed is a week of empty nights you never get back: hiring a designer launches you 4–6 weeks faster than DIY, and launching even a month sooner can mean \$5K–\$15K in extra bookings during peak season.

One rule for the whole timeline: if you hire help, approve mood boards and picks within 24 hours. You are the bottleneck if you let yourself be.

Pre-Close (Under Contract)

- ☐ **Audit your top 3–5 comps** before you invest a dollar. Their reviews tell you what to build and what to avoid.
- ☐ **Complete the Design Plan Checklist** (in this pack): guest avatar, capacity plan, style lane, palette, repeated elements, signature moment.
- ☐ **Decide DIY, hybrid, or full-service.** DIY runs \$10–\$20 per square foot plus your labor; a design-only plan runs \$3K–\$5K; full-service all-in commonly lands at \$20K–\$40K+ on the 4 bed, 3 bath home we recommend. Run the ROI math; under 18 months payback, spend the money.
- ☐ **Measure and plan the rooms.** Scan rooms with a phone app like Polycam for exact measurements, build scaled layouts in a room-planner app (we use Spoak), and track budget, purchases, and delivery dates in Google Sheets.
- ☐ **Validate amenities with market data** (Rabbu or similar) before anything goes in a cart. Hot tub, fire pit, game room: buy what your own market's data supports.
- ☐ **Load the carts, order nothing.** Deals fall through. Wayfair for beds, sofas, and rugs; Amazon for essentials; Target for accents; Article for higher-end pull-outs; Costco for hot tubs and appliances; Facebook Marketplace for local rustic finds; Walmart and Home Depot for inexpensive furniture, rugs, and outdoor gear.
- ☐ **Line up contractor bids** for paint and fixtures so work begins Day 1 after closing.
- ☐ **Book the photographer now.** The shoot lands in week 3 or 4 and gates everything downstream.

Closing Day

- ☐ **Hit "order" on the major pieces:** beds, bunks, mattresses, sofas, dining table. Deliver to the property or a storage unit.
- ☐ **Keep a master list** matching every order number to its room. It keeps things simple for whoever unpacks.

Week 1. Paint and Prep

- ☐ **Contractor work underway:** paint and fixtures only. Skip full remodels, luxury flooring, high-end appliances, and anything structural; structural changes are never worth the timeline delays.



- ☐ Splurge where the camera sees it: mattresses (\$300–\$500 per bed), linens and pillows (\$200–\$300 per bed), lighting, paint, art and décor.
- ☐ Pre-order any remaining major furniture.
- ☐ Quick wins as budget allows: swapped light fixtures, peel-and-stick backsplash, oversized prints or mirrors, front-door and outdoor-lighting refresh, fire pit.

Week 2. Delivery and Assembly

- ☐ Furniture arriving; check every order against the master list.
- ☐ Hire local hands for assembly (TaskRabbit, Thumbtack, or your handyman; cleaners often take setup work gladly).
- ☐ Give your team a printed setup checklist with photos, order summaries with tracking info, room-by-room placement instructions, and your emergency contact. Have them send photos as they go.
- ☐ Approve any designer picks within 24 hours.

Week 3. Styling and Staging

- ☐ Interior styling and décor: rugs anchored, art hung, lamps placed, textures layered.
- ☐ Build the lifestyle setups that sell the dream: coffee station, s'mores kit at the fire pit, wine on the patio.
- ☐ Stock and stage by the Kitchen and Bathroom Items Checklists (in this pack).
- ☐ Create a detailed inventory checklist.
- ☐ Confirm the photographer for this week or next.

Week 4. Install Complete and Photos

- ☐ Walk the property as the largest group the listing claims to hold. Every spot where the last sleeper has nowhere to sit, eat, or set down a coffee will show up in your reviews.
- ☐ Run the full staging checklist: pillows styled, throws layered, cords and bins hidden, beds hotel-crisp, table set for max occupancy, fire pit staged, hot tub cover visible, string lights on.
- ☐ Photo prep: declutter every surface, close the toilet lids, adjust the blinds, turn on every light in the house.
- ☐ **Professional photography shoot.** Hand the photographer the Photo Shot List from this pack. A pro with a plan beats a pro guessing.
- ☐ If the edits or tint are off, mass-edit the set (photolab.teeco.co or any editor that gets the whole set consistent), then curate like a hotel listing.

Design install done. The listing build, pricing ladder, and launch live in the Six-Week Launch Checklist, weeks 4 through 6.